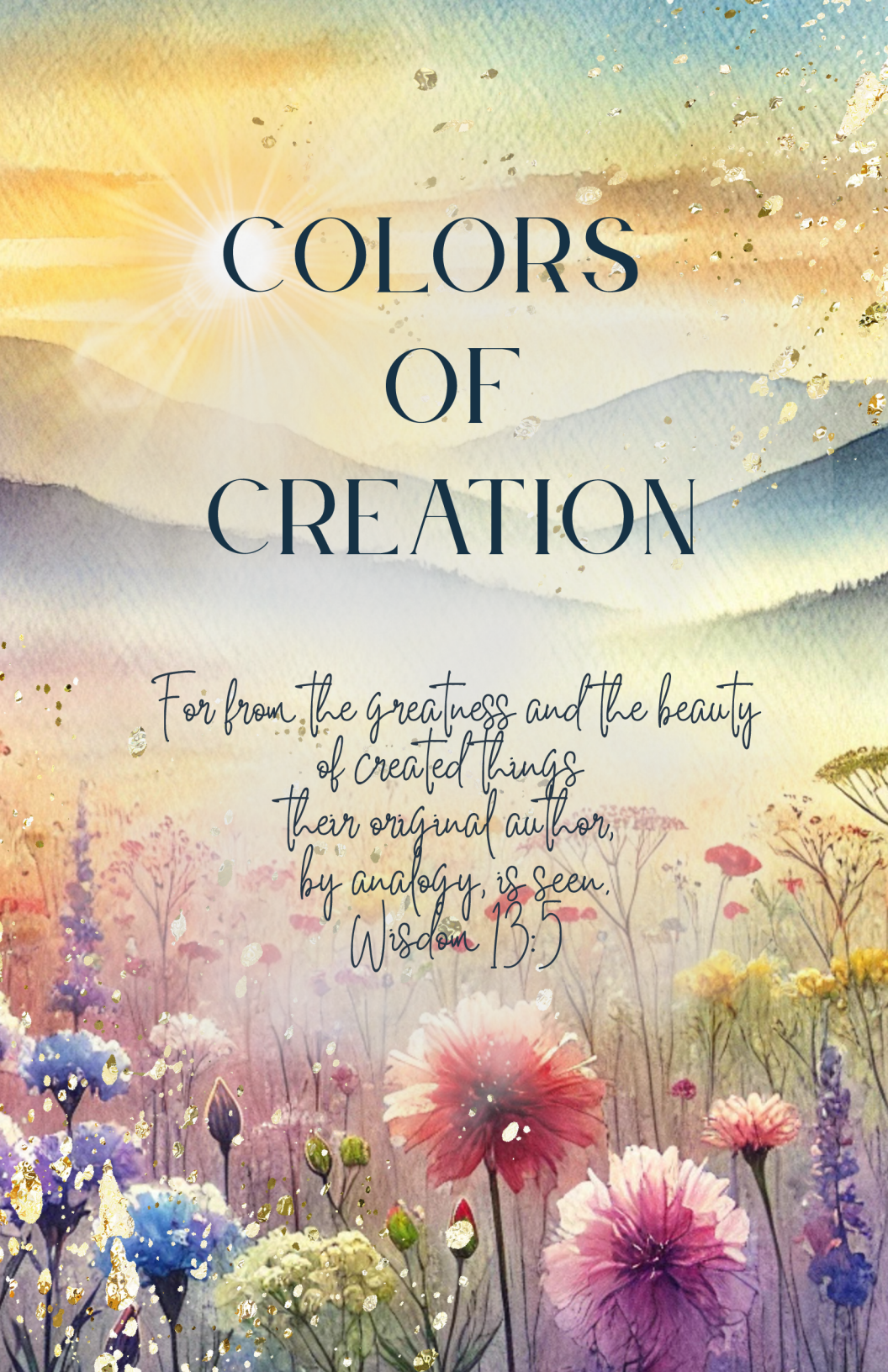


The background is a watercolor illustration. At the top, a sunburst with yellow and orange rays emanates from the left. Below the sun, there are layers of mountains in shades of blue, green, and yellow. The foreground is filled with a variety of flowers, including large red and pink daisies, blue cornflowers, and purple lupines. The entire scene is decorated with small, golden, star-like speckles.

COLORS OF CREATION

For from the greatness and the beauty
of created things
their original author,
by analogy, is seen.
Wisdom 13:5



iris

WEEK FOUR

COLORS OF CREATION

Opening Prayer

God of all creation,

Who made each season with it's own unique
beauty,
Shine your light in my heart, and open my eyes
To see the colors You created in me.
Amen

For from the greatness and the beauty of
created things their original author, by
analogy, is seen.
Wisdom 13:5



Song for Reflection:
Spring - Vivaldi



OUR GUIDE

St. Hildegard of Bingen

Doctor of Viriditas



All of creation is a symphony of the Holy Spirit.

THEIR STORY

- ✦ **Early Life:** Born in 1098 in Germany, the youngest of ten children. From a young age, she began experiencing visions that would continue throughout her life.
- ✦ **Formation:** She was sent to live with nuns, who taught her to read and write. She studied music, learning to play the psaltery (harp), and eventually composed many hymns and antiphons still sung today.
- ✦ **A Musical Legacy:** Of all composers from the Middle Ages, none left us more works than Hildegard. She is one of the few composers credited with writing both music and lyrics.
- ✦ **The Visions:** Though her visions began in early childhood, she did not write of them until age 42, when she felt called by God to share them with the world. She described experiencing the Light of God through all five senses — what she called "the reflection of the living Light."
- ✦ **Her Works:** In addition to music, she wrote on theology, natural medicine, and corresponded through many letters.
- ✦ **Her Legacy:** In 2012, Pope Benedict XVI named her a Doctor of the Church. She is honored as the patron saint of creativity, artists, musicians, and writers. Hildegard saw light and harmony in all creation — to her, beauty was not vanity but vitality. She reminds us that when we honor our God-given beauty, we participate in His creative artistry. Her feast day is September 17th.

THE TIMBRE OF YOUR SONG

✦ What is timbre?

- In music, timbre (pronounced TAM-ber) is the tone quality that makes every instrument distinct.
- Two instruments can play the exact same note at the same volume and still sound completely different — a cello and an oboe playing middle C are unmistakably themselves.
- That uniqueness — that irreplaceable tone color — is called timbre.

✦ You have a timbre.

- God chose a specific palette of warm or cool, light or deep, clear or soft — and He painted it into your skin, your hair, your eyes.
- Your coloring is not an accident or an afterthought. It is your God-given tone color: the hue of your instrument in His symphony.
- When Hildegard wrote that "all of creation is a symphony of the Holy Spirit," she meant it literally. Your colors are part of the score.

✦ Why this matters.

- Discovering your seasonal color palette is not a fashion exercise. It is an act of attention — learning to see what God intentionally designed.
- When you wear colors that harmonize with your natural palette, your face lights up and people see you — not what you're wearing.
- The colors become a frame that honors the masterpiece within.

AN OVERVIEW

What is Seasonal Color Analysis?

What it is

- Seasonal color analysis is a framework for identifying the natural color palette that harmonizes best with your unique coloring — your skin tone, hair, and eyes taken together.
- The idea is simple: certain colors bring out your features, make your skin glow, and help people see you. Others drain you, create shadows, or pull attention away from your face.
- Your season is the family of colors that works with what God built into you rather than against it.

Where it came from

- The foundations were laid by Swiss artist and educator Johannes Itten in the early 20th century, who noticed that his students instinctively used colors that reflected their own natural coloring.
- American image consultant Suzanne Caygill developed the seasonal framework further in the 1950s and 60s, connecting personal coloring to seasonal color families.
- It was widely popularized in the 1980s through Carole Jackson's book *Color Me Beautiful*, which introduced the four-season system to a mainstream audience.
- The framework has continued to evolve — today's 12-season tonal system offers greater nuance and precision than the original four categories.

AN OVERVIEW, CONTINUED

What it is not

- It is not a fashion rule that tells you what you're allowed to wear.
- It is not a verdict on your worth, your beauty, or how you compare to other women.
- It is not a box. Your season is a starting point, not a ceiling.
- It is not about spending money or overhauling your wardrobe.

Why we're doing it here

- Your coloring was not a random occurrence. God chose the specific palette of your features — the warmth or coolness of your skin, the depth or lightness of your eyes, the hue of your hair — with the same intentionality He brought to every created thing.
- Learning to see and honor that palette is an act of gratitude and stewardship. It is a way of saying: I see what You made. I receive it.
- This is not vanity. Hildegard of Bingen taught that beauty is vitality — a reflection of God's living light in creation. When you honor the beauty He placed in you, you participate in His creative artistry.

WHAT TO EXPECT

What to expect in this session

- You'll learn the three dimensions of color that determine your season.
- You'll read descriptions of all four seasons and twelve sub-seasons.
- You'll do simple self-observation tests to begin identifying your palette.
- You'll take the Colors of Creation quiz in your portal to get your result.
- Then you'll bring it all to prayer — and let it change the way you see yourself.



His beauty shining in every hue

THE THREE COMPONENTS OF COLOR

The Building Blocks of Your Palette

Every season — and every person's coloring — is a combination of three qualities. Understanding these first makes everything that follows make sense.

Temperature: Warm vs. Cool The most fundamental dimension — every color has an underlying base of either yellow (warm) or blue (cool), and so does your coloring.

- Warm: golden, peachy, or olive undertones. Gold jewelry tends to flatter.
- Cool: pink or rosy undertones. Silver jewelry tends to flatter.
- Neutral: a balance of both.
- Note: how fair or dark your skin is has nothing to do with temperature. A very fair woman can be warm; a deep-skinned woman can be cool.

THE THREE COMPONENTS OF COLOR, CONTINUED

Value: Light vs. Deep The overall lightness or darkness of your features — hair, skin, and eyes considered together.

- Light: features are all on the lighter end, little variation between them.
- Deep: features are rich and dark, depth is the defining quality.
- Tip: a black-and-white photo helps you see value clearly.

Chroma: Clear vs. Soft The intensity of your coloring — how vivid and contrasted your features are versus how blended and muted.

- Clear/Bright: high contrast between features. Saturated colors complement this.
- Soft/Muted: low contrast, features blend together gently. Muted colors complement this; bright ones can overwhelm.
- Tip: in your B&W photo, look at how much contrast exists between your hair, skin, and eyes.

Your season is the combination of these three. Most women have one dominant characteristic that defines them most strongly — finding it is the key to finding your season.

THE FOUR SEASONS OF COLOR

Each season carries its own light — a reflection of God's artistry in creation.

In discovering your palette, you're simply learning to notice the colors that mirror the life He's placed within you.



Spring – Radiant Renewal

Warm, light, clear.

Spring women have golden or peachy undertones, light-to-medium coloring, and a bright, fresh quality to their features.

- Colors: peach, coral, warm turquoise, leaf green, golden yellow.
- Effect: glows like morning sunlight — warm and vivid without being heavy.

Summer – Gentle Grace

Cool, light, soft.

Summer women have pink or rosy undertones, light-to-medium coloring, and a soft, muted quality — low contrast between features.

- Colors: dusty rose, powder blue, lavender, soft teal, silver gray.
- Effect: radiates quiet peace. Stark contrast or warm tones can overwhelm.

THE FOUR SEASONS OF COLOR, CONTINUED

Autumn – Golden Abundance

Warm, deep, soft.

Autumn women have golden or olive undertones, medium-to-deep coloring, and a rich, muted quality — warmth is the defining note.

- Colors: terracotta, olive, teal, warm brown, mustard.
- Effect: reflects warmth, confidence, and strength. Cool or bright colors often fight the natural richness.

Winter – Luminous Clarity

Cool, deep, clear.

Winter women have cool or neutral undertones, often medium-to-deep coloring, and high contrast between features.

- Colors: crimson, sapphire, emerald, pure white, black.
- Effect: vivid and serene, like still light on ice. Muted or warm tones can flatten Winter's natural drama.

THE 12 SUB-SEASONS

Spring

◆ **TRUE SPRING** (Warm Spring) The purest Spring expression — warmth is the dominant note. Golden-toned skin, medium golden-brown to golden-blond hair, warm brown, hazel, or warm blue eyes. Colors: warm coral, golden yellow, clear turquoise, bright warm green. Glows in clear, warm hues.



◆ **LIGHT SPRING** Spring's warmth meets Summer's delicacy. Very fair, light coloring — blonde or very light golden-brown hair, light eyes, delicate skin. Colors: soft peach, light warm pink, pale aqua, light warm gold. Luminous in light, warm, clear colors. Heavy or dark shades overwhelm.



◆ **BRIGHT SPRING** Spring's most vivid expression — bordering Winter's clarity. High contrast between features; vivid eyes, clearer skin. Colors: bright coral, hot turquoise, vivid warm green, clear warm red. Can carry more intensity than other Springs. Clarity is the key.



THE 12 SUB-SEASONS

Summer

◆ **TRUE SUMMER** (Cool Summer) The purest Summer expression — coolness and softness together. Rosy or pink undertone, ash-brown or ash-blond hair, cool gray or blue eyes. Colors: dusty rose, powder blue, lavender, soft teal. Polished and graceful. Warmth or high contrast feels jarring.



◆ **LIGHT SUMMER** Summer's lightest expression — extremely delicate, fair coloring. Very light ash-blond or silver-toned hair, light blue or cool gray eyes. Colors: ice pink, pale lavender, light cool blue, soft mint. The palest of all seasons. Depth overwhelms; the lightest cool colors shine.



◆ **SOFT SUMMER** The most muted of all seasons — bridging Autumn's earthiness. Medium, blended features with no strong contrast; ash-brown hair, soft blue-gray or brown eyes. Colors: dusty mauve, muted teal, soft cocoa, grayed blue. Softness is the guide. Both warmth and brightness feel too sharp.



THE 12 SUB-SEASONS

Autumn

◆ **TRUE AUTUMN** (Warm Autumn) The purest Autumn expression — rich, warm, earth-toned. Golden or olive skin, warm-brown hair often with reddish or golden highlights, warm brown or hazel eyes. Colors: terracotta, olive, teal, mustard, warm brown. Earth tones make the features glow. Cool or bright colors can look discordant.



◆ **DEEP AUTUMN** The deepest Autumn — sharing Winter's depth while keeping Autumn's warmth. Deep warm-brown to black-brown hair, deep warm-brown eyes, medium-dark to deep golden or olive skin. Colors: deep burgundy, chocolate, forest green, deep gold, rust. The richest warm tones are home. True Winter's cool depth falls flat.



◆ **SOFT AUTUMN** The most muted Autumn — bridging Summer's softness. Light-to-medium warm-neutral coloring; light golden-brown hair, soft warm-hazel or brown eyes. Colors: warm taupe, camel, soft rust, muted gold, warm khaki. Brightness is too sharp; soft, warm, muted tones bring out a quiet radiance.



THE 12 SUB-SEASONS

Winter

♦ **TRUE WINTER** (Cool Winter) The purest Winter expression — cool, deep, high contrast. Dark hair, dark eyes, cool or neutral-pink skin. Colors: true red, royal blue, emerald, pure white, black. Pure cool contrast makes this woman striking. Warm or muted colors flatten and disappear.



♦ **DEEP WINTER** The deepest Winter — sharing Autumn's depth with Winter's cool base. Near-black hair, very deep eyes, deeper skin with cool or neutral undertone. Colors: deep burgundy, dark navy, black, deep plum, rich forest green. Can carry even richer and deeper versions of Winter's palette. True Autumn's warmth doesn't land.



♦ **BRIGHT WINTER** Winter's most vivid expression — sharing Spring's clarity. Very high contrast with a vivid, almost electric quality. Dark hair, light skin, striking vivid eyes. Colors: shocking pink, icy pastels, bright cobalt, vivid emerald, clear warm red. Extreme clarity is the key. Both warmth and mutedness dull the features.



THE 6 DOMINANT CHARACTERISTICS

The four seasons combine six qualities. You can also look at them as spectrums to find which characteristic defines you most strongly.

The Three Spectrums of Color:

Cool ————— Warm

Deep ————— Light

Clear ————— Soft

Your dominant characteristic is the quality that stands out most in your overall coloring. It's your anchor — the thing that stays true even when other dimensions feel unclear.

THE FLOW SEASONS

Some women find their results fall close between two seasons. This is not a flaw — it reflects that color is a spectrum, not a set of boxes. These close pairs are called flow seasons, and they share a dominant characteristic across the temperature divide:

Dominant

Flow Pair

Light

Light Spring ↔ Light Summer



Bright/Clear

Bright Spring ↔ Bright Winter



Warm

True Spring ↔ True Autumn



Soft/Muted

Soft Summer ↔ Soft Autumn



Cool

True Summer ↔ True Winter



Deep

Dark Autumn ↔ Dark Winter



KNOW THYSELF

Record your quiz result before continuing.

- My season is:
- My sub-season is:
- My dominant characteristic is:



Read your sub-season description again slowly. Which phrases felt like recognition — like someone had finally named something you already knew?

Was there anything in your result that surprised you, or that you resisted at first? What do you think is underneath that reaction?

Think about the colors you have always been drawn to — in your wardrobe, your home, your favorite places. Do they align with your palette, or contradict it?

KNOW THYSELF, CONTINUED

Go to your closet. Pull out the items you reach for most — the ones that feel most like you. What do they have in common? Do they align with your season?

Pull out something you own but rarely wear. Look at the color. Does it conflict with your palette — or is there something else going on?

Is there a color you have avoided because you were told it wasn't "for you" — or because you didn't think you could pull it off? Does your palette give you permission to revisit that?

If your coloring is a reflection of how God made you — warm or cool, light or deep, vivid or soft — what does your palette say about the quality of you He was going for?

BRING IT TO GOD

Begin with quiet reflection. Ask Jesus to help you see yourself with wonder — as part of His creation, radiant and intentional.

God chose your palette the same way He chose the colors of every created thing — with intention, with love, and with His own beauty in mind. Sit with that for a moment. What does it stir in you?

Hildegard taught that beauty is not vanity but vitality — a reflection of God's living light. Have you ever felt guilty for caring about how you look? How does this reframe that guilt?

Is there a part of your appearance you have spent years wishing were different — a feature, a coloring, a quality? Bring it before God now. Ask Him to show you what He sees when He looks at it.

BRING IT TO GOD, CONTINUED

Wearing your colors is an act of stewardship — honoring the gift He gave you rather than fighting it. What would it look like to approach getting dressed as an act of gratitude rather than an act of performance?

Which colors in the world make you feel most joyful, most alive, most yourself? Ask God what He wants you to know about why He built that response into you.

*For from the greatness and the beauty of created things their original author, by analogy, is seen.
Wisdom 13:5*

LIVING IT OUT

This week is about observing and noticing — not shopping, not overhauling, not fixing. Just paying attention. Finding your colors is not about boxing you in. It's about discovering what makes you the star of the show.

The Glow Check Go through your existing clothes this week. Pull out the items you reach for again and again — the ones that feel most like you.

Do those favorites align with your palette? What do you notice about their color temperature, depth, or intensity?

The Drain Check Pull out something you own but rarely wear. Look at the color honestly.

Does it conflict with your palette — too warm, too cool, too bright, too muted? Or is something else keeping you from wearing it?

Makeup Exploration Look at the makeup you currently own. Is your blush cool-pink or peachy-warm? Is your lipstick blue-red or orange-red?

Based on your season, do you think your current makeup is working with your undertones or against them?

LIVING IT OUT, CONTINUED

Begin with quiet reflection. Ask Jesus to help you see yourself with wonder — as part of His creation, radiant and intentional.

Pause in Prayer Before you observe anything this week, ask God to quiet the critical voice — the one that evaluates and compares and finds lacking. Ask Him to give you His eyes. Then look.

Observe Each morning this week, take a moment to notice color — in nature, in your surroundings, in what you choose to wear. Which colors draw you? Which make you feel most at home?

Reflect How do these colors make you feel when you wear or surround yourself with them? Peaceful? Energized? Confident? Comforted? Notice without judging the response.

Connect What might your color preferences reveal about how God designed you — not just physically, but in quality and character? Write a few words or phrases that describe how you feel most yourself.

THIS WEEK

Each morning this week, take a moment to notice color — in nature, in your surroundings, or in what you wear.

Pause to whisper:

“Lord, thank You for the beauty You’ve placed within creation — and within me.”

Let this awareness become a prayer of praise throughout your day.

Closing Prayer

Creator God,
You fill the world with color and light.
Thank You for making me part of Your
masterpiece.

Teach me to see beauty through Your eyes
and to reflect Your light in the colors of my life.
Amen.



*Every creature is a glittering, glistening
mirror of Divinity.
— St. Hildegard of Bingen*



MY SEASON PORTRAIT

My Color Season:

My sub-season:

My dominant characteristic:

The colors that make me glow:

A color I want to bring more of into my life,
and why:

What my palette reveals about how God
made me:

